

August 20, 2026

Cigna Healthcare
Cigna Appeals Unit
P.O. Box 188011
Chattanooga, TN 37422

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Mohamed Hermann (MRN MUSC1465392), Claim MUSC-BC1F-3

Patient	Mohamed Hermann (DOB 1996-10-29)
MRN	MUSC1465392
Member ID / Group	CIG627241918 / GRP-90544
Claim number	MUSC-BC1F-3
Date of service	2025-12-29
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$400.66
Denial code	CARC 204 / RARC N130 — This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-18

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Mohamed Hermann (MRN: MUSC1465392, Member ID: CIG627241918, Group: GRP-90544) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-BC1F-3 for services rendered on December 29, 2025, at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center, Mount Pleasant, SC. Cigna Healthcare denied the claim in full on February 19, 2026, citing CARC 204 ("This service/equipment/drug is not covered under the patient's current benefit plan") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating the service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination and requests a full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$223.68.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

On December 29, 2025, Mr. Hermann, a 29-year-old established male patient, presented to MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center for an outpatient evaluation and management visit rendered by Daniel R. Okafor, MD (NPI 1558493021). The encounter was billed under CPT code 99214, representing an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and a secondary diagnosis of R69. The claim was submitted on January 8, 2026, with a billed charge of \$400.66. The service was provided in an on-campus outpatient hospital setting (Place of Service 22, Revenue Code 0510). Mr. Hermann's Cigna Healthcare Advantage plan carries a coverage period of January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, and was active at the time of service.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of CPT 99214 as a non-covered benefit is not consistent with the nature of the service provided. CPT 99214 is a standard evaluation and management code representing a medically necessary outpatient visit for an established patient presenting with an acute condition. Evaluation and management services of this type are among the most fundamental components of outpatient medical care and are broadly covered under commercial health benefit plans. A blanket exclusion of a moderate-complexity established-patient office visit would be highly atypical under any comprehensive commercial plan, and Cigna has not provided specific contractual language or a benefit exclusion category sufficient to substantiate this denial.

MUSC Health requests that Cigna Healthcare identify with specificity the benefit exclusion provision under the Cigna Healthcare Advantage plan document that applies to this service. Without that specificity, the denial does not meet the standard of a reasoned coverage determination. Furthermore, the claim was submitted timely, the rendering provider is an enrolled participating provider under the applicable plan, the member's coverage was active on the date of service, and the diagnosis and procedure code are appropriately matched. There is no coding discrepancy, authorization issue, or coordination-of-benefits concern reflected in the denial record. The sole stated basis is a benefit exclusion, which MUSC Health contends has not been adequately supported.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Cigna Healthcare conduct a complete review of this appeal, identify the specific plan exclusion language relied upon in issuing the denial, and reverse the denial in full. Upon reversal, MUSC Health requests that payment be issued at the contracted allowed amount of \$223.68 in accordance with the terms of the participating provider agreement. Should Cigna uphold the denial, MUSC Health requests a written explanation citing the precise benefit document section and exclusion language applicable to CPT 99214 as billed on this claim, so that further appeal options may be evaluated. This appeal is submitted within the deadline of August 18, 2026, through the appropriate channel as directed in the denial notice.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC
Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management

MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record